

A collection of playing cards. On the left, a heart suit card with a red heart pattern and a small illustration of a crown. In the center, a club suit card with a black club pattern and a small illustration of a crown. On the right, a diamond suit card with a red diamond pattern and a small illustration of a crown. Below these, a fan of cards showing various ranks and suits: Q of hearts, 9 of hearts, 5 of hearts, 4 of hearts, K of clubs, Q of clubs, 9 of clubs, 7 of clubs, A of diamonds, 5 of diamonds, 2 of diamonds, Q of spades, and 2 of spades.

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

A collection of playing cards. At the top, four cards are displayed vertically: the Queen of Clubs, the Jack of Diamonds, the King of Spades, and the Ace of Hearts. Below these, a fan of cards is shown, starting with the Jack of Clubs on the left and fanning out to the 2 of Hearts on the right. The cards in the fan, from left to right, are: Jack of Clubs, 10 of Clubs, 9 of Clubs, 5 of Clubs, Ace of Diamonds, King of Diamonds, 10 of Diamonds, 9 of Diamonds, Ace of Spades, Queen of Spades, 9 of Spades, 8 of Hearts, and 2 of Hearts. A single red heart symbol is also visible at the bottom right of the fan.

Count Sure Winners				
				Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 8 5 4
♥ 10 6
♦ K 9 7 3
♣ A J 2

♠ Q 2

♥ Q 9 5 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ K Q 9 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 3

♥ J 3 2

♦ Q J 10 8

♣ 8 6 5 4

♠ K J 9 7 6

♥ A K 8 7

♦ 6 4

♣ 10 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

You have 12 points and you respond 1 ♠. Partner rebids 1NT. What do you say next?

Partner has 12-14 points, balanced. You have an excellent 4-card ♥ suit, but if you bid 2 ♥ right now it is not forcing on partner and he will almost surely pass. And you definitely don't have the points to jump to 3 ♥. New Minor Forcing gives you a way out.

So you say 2 ♦ and your wonderful partner bids 2 ♥. What now?

Your 12 points just got upgraded! Bid 4 ♥.

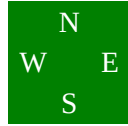
Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 5 2
 ♥ A J 10 7 4
 ♦ J 5
 ♣ Q 7 4

♠ J 10 8 6
 ♥ K Q 9 5
 ♦ 7 4 3 2
 ♣ K



♠ A Q 9
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ A K 10 9
 ♣ J 10 9 5

♠ 7 4 3
 ♥ 6 3
 ♦ Q 8 6
 ♣ A 8 6 3 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♦	Pass
1 ♥	Pass	1NT	Pass
2 ♣	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			

This 14 point hand is almost good enough to open 1NT, but you bid 1 ♦. Partner responds 1 ♥.

You could bid either 1NT or 2 ♣. You decide on 1NT.

Partner says 2 ♣.

This is NMF, asking if you have 3 ♥s. You only have 2, but you have a great notrump hand now. Since partner must have at least invitational strength you jump right to 3NT.